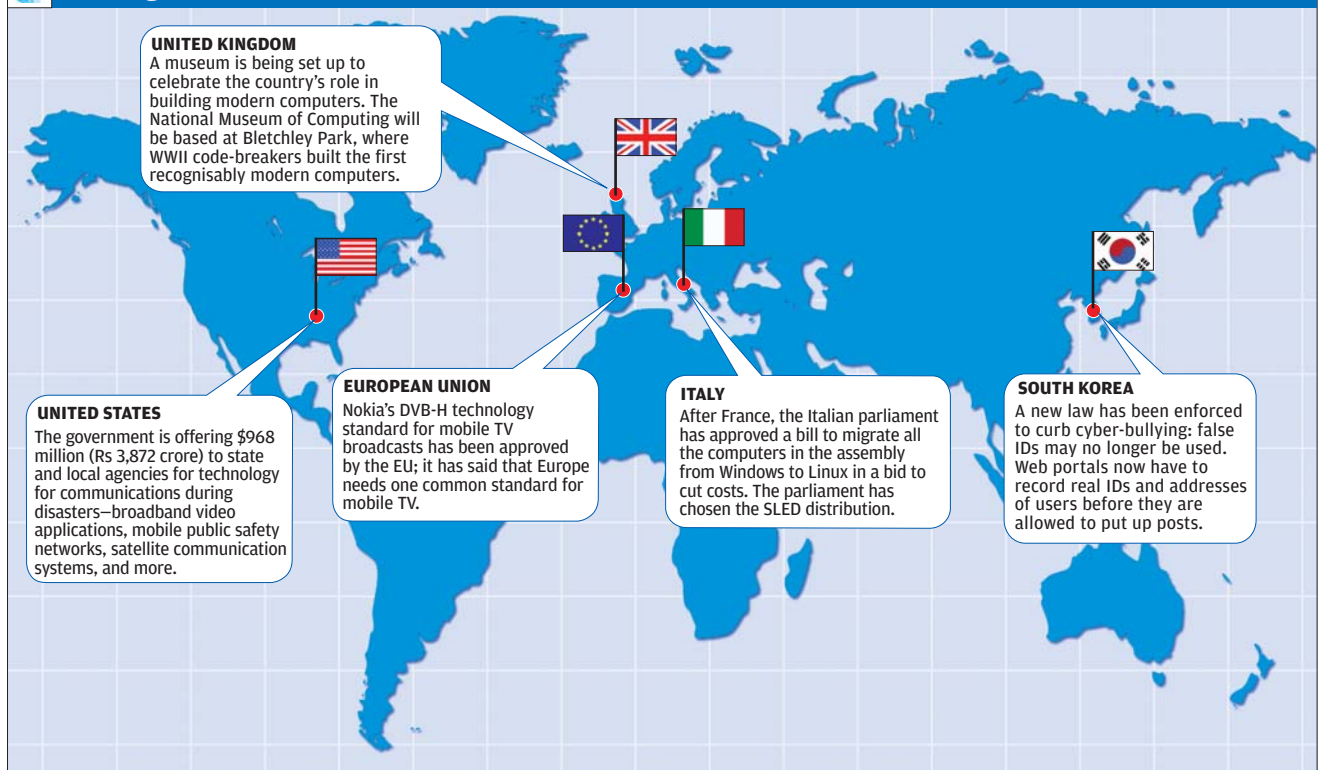




to better handle the privacy of users' search query history.

Whether these privacy-maintaining steps will be successful or not, users will certainly feel better about it. Users need no longer feel "under surveillance," and also, the chances of misusing data would be reduced. Search portals seem to be looking to protect you: still, they need industry consensus and collaboration to make the move a success.

AGAIN...

## Chips Off The Clock

**A**ge old rival warlords Intel and AMD seem to be ever creating some buzz or the other to remain in the news. Their rivalry in the silicon chip market continues to keep the media orchestra playing. Both recently announced the roadmaps of their next-generation processors, creating yet

another buzz in the chip market and getting consumers all excited.

Intel gave out additional details of their 45nm processors—Penryn—due out later this year. Also, Intel shared a few details of their next-generation architecture called Nehalem for its Penryn processors. On their mobile platform Santa Rosa, fresh new mobile Penryn Core 2 Duos will be available before the next generation Montevina mobile processors.

On other hand, to catch up with the quad-cores from Intel, AMD's quad-core Barcelona's performance reports are yet to come. AMD spoke about GPGPU flexibility and their Fusion processors. Also, AMD announced plans for their second-generation Stars (quad-core and dual-core), and the single-core Sparta processors. AMD also announced their 65nm Athlon 64 refreshed single-core Lima processor would be replaced by Sparta, set for launch in September 2007.

Call it leapfrogging or a

bullfight, but the two chip giants seem to enjoy sharing their plans and leaving consumers confused with processor code-names! The processor wars took a twist when Intel announced Core 2 Duo stepping and price-cuts of as much as 50 per cent for the Core 2 Duo series. Also, fresh quad-core processors will soon join the Quad family. Following in Intel's steps, AMD, too, announced a price cut for their single-core and dual-core processors.

What's been done is nothing new except for the sharing of their processor roadmaps. However, the timing creates a situation where the possibility of loss due to price cuts haunts AMD. If Barcelona outperforms and meets expectations, Intel stands to suffer from the price cut. But if, on the other hand, Barcelona fails to cut it, AMD would have to cut prices, which could even compel them to change their roadmap. AMD has already suffered a \$600 million (Rs 2,400 crore)

loss in 2nd quarter of 2007.

Both will be affected by their price cut strategies, and as usual, the consumer will have more options. But the upcoming processors will only make consumers drool if there are revolutionary features added to the cores rather than evolutionary functions. All this is yet another case of the rivalry heating up, and we cannot help but report it!

THE CLASSMATE PC

## Will These Dinkies Deliver?

**T**he much-awaited learning companion for students, Intel's Classmate PC is finally here. Intel and HCL Infosystems launched it last month. The launch of the Classmate PC is part of Intel's World Ahead Program (WAP) for promoting technology as learning and teaching tool.